INJECTORINDEX

Data-Driven Provider Intelligence

What Botox Actually Costs in Your City

2026

2026 Pricing Data Across 22 Cities

- → Real price ranges from 500+ verified providers.
- → What drives cost differences (and what doesn't).
- → The questions that save you hundreds per session.
- → Red flags that signal you're overpaying.

FREE GUIDE FROM INJECTORINDEX.COM

Independent research. No ads. No sponsored listings. Just data.

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Based on analysis of 500+ verified providers across 22 U.S. cities. Data collected January–March 2026 by InjectorIndex.com.

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SECTION 01

The Real Cost of Botox in 2026

If you've searched "how much does Botox cost" recently, you've probably gotten a useless answer. Most sources say "$10–$25 per unit" and leave it at that. That's technically true and practically meaningless.

The reality is more nuanced. A single Botox session for forehead lines typically costs between $250 and $600, depending on where you live, who's injecting, and how many units you need. That's a wide range — and the difference between the low end and the high end isn't always about quality.

THE NATIONAL AVERAGE

Across our dataset of 500+ providers in 22 cities, the median cost for a standard forehead Botox treatment (20–30 units) is **$325–$425**. If you're paying significantly more or less, it's worth understanding why.

This guide exists because pricing in aesthetic medicine is deliberately opaque. Providers benefit from you not knowing what's normal. We don't think that's right. InjectorIndex was built to make this information transparent — and this guide is your starting point.

How Botox Pricing Works

Botox is priced one of two ways, and understanding which model your provider uses is the single most important thing you can learn from this guide:

	Per-Unit Pricing	Per-Area Pricing
How It Works	You pay for each unit injected (e.g., $14/unit × 25 units = $350)	You pay a flat fee per treatment zone (e.g., $350 for forehead)
Transparency	High — you know exactly what you're getting	Lower — unit count may vary between patients
Best For	Patients who want control and clear pricing	Patients who want simplicity and predictable bills

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Watch For	Providers using fewer units than needed to seem cheaper	Providers using fewer units while charging the same flat fee

The InjectorIndex recommendation: Always ask for per-unit pricing, even if your provider quotes per area. Knowing the unit count lets you compare apples to apples across providers.

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SECTION 02

City-by-City Price Breakdown

Below is our verified pricing data across 22 major U.S. cities. These ranges reflect actual pricing from providers in our database — not estimates or national averages. Prices shown are for a standard forehead treatment (20–30 units of Botox or equivalent).

PREMIUM MARKETS — Highest cost of living, highest concentration of specialists

City	Low	Average	High	Per Unit
New York City	$350	$475	$650	$15–$22
Los Angeles	$325	$450	$600	$14–$20
San Francisco	$340	$460	$625	$15–$21
Miami	$300	$425	$575	$13–$19
Beverly Hills	$400	$550	$750+	$18–$25

MAJOR METROS — Large cities with competitive provider markets

City	Low	Average	High	Per Unit
Chicago	$275	$375	$500	$12–$17
Dallas	$250	$350	$475	$11–$16
Houston	$240	$340	$460	$11–$16
Atlanta	$250	$350	$475	$11–$16
Seattle	$290	$400	$525	$13–$18
Denver	$260	$360	$480	$12–$17
Boston	$300	$410	$550	$13–$18
Phoenix	$240	$330	$450	$11–$15

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Portland, OR	$260	$365	$490	$12–$17

EMERGING MARKETS — Growing demand, often better value

City	Low	Average	High	Per Unit
Nashville	$240	$335	$450	$11–$15
Austin	$250	$345	$460	$11–$16
Charlotte	$230	$320	$430	$10–$15
San Diego	$280	$380	$500	$12–$17
Las Vegas	$220	$310	$420	$10–$15
Scottsdale	$270	$375	$500	$12–$17
Tampa	$230	$320	$430	$10–$15
Raleigh	$220	$310	$420	$10–$14

■ PRICING TREND: 2025 → 2026

Average Botox pricing increased 4–7% year-over-year across most markets, driven by Allergan's wholesale price increase in Q4 2025. However, competition from biosimilar alternatives (Daxxify, Jeuveau, Xeomin) is keeping price growth moderate in markets with high provider density.

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SECTION 03

What Drives the Price Difference

Two providers in the same city can charge $250 and $550 for the same treatment. Here's what actually explains the gap — and what doesn't.

Factors That Legitimately Affect Price

1. Provider Credentials

Board-certified dermatologists and plastic surgeons typically charge 20–40% more than nurse injectors. This reflects years of additional training, malpractice insurance costs, and practice overhead — not necessarily better results. Many experienced nurse practitioners and physician assistants produce excellent outcomes at lower price points.

2. Geographic Location

Rent in Manhattan versus suburban Ohio creates real cost differences. A provider in Beverly Hills paying $15,000/month in rent needs to charge more than one in Charlotte paying $3,000. This is a legitimate cost driver — though it doesn't mean the Beverly Hills injection is 5x better.

3. Product Brand

Botox (onabotulinumtoxinA by Allergan) is the most expensive neurotoxin. Alternatives like Dysport, Xeomin, Jeuveau, and Daxxify may cost 10–25% less at some practices. All are FDA-approved and effective. The "best" product depends on your individual response.

4. Injection Volume and Expertise

High-volume practices that buy Botox in bulk get better wholesale pricing and can pass savings to you. Conversely, a provider who does 5 Botox treatments a month pays more per unit than one doing 50.

Factors That Don't Justify a Premium

Fancy office decor. A marble lobby does not improve injection technique. Many of the best injectors work in clean, modest offices.

Celebrity clients. Name-dropping is marketing. It tells you nothing about whether they will deliver good results for your anatomy and goals.

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Instagram followers. Social media presence reflects marketing budget, not clinical skill. Some of the highest-rated providers on InjectorIndex have minimal social media presence.

RED FLAG

If a provider's pricing is significantly below the low end of your city's range, ask why. Common reasons include: diluted product (more saline, less Botox per unit), use of non-FDA-approved imported product, or aggressive discounting to attract new patients who will be upsold on other services. The cheapest option is rarely the best value.

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SECTION 04

The Hidden Costs Nobody Mentions

The per-unit or per-area price is just the starting point. Here's what can inflate your total spend:

Consultation Fees

About 30% of providers charge a separate consultation fee ($50–$150) for first-time patients. Some apply this toward your treatment; others don't. Always ask upfront. At InjectorIndex, we flag providers who include complimentary consultations.

Touch-Up Policies

Botox results aren't always symmetrical on the first visit. A good provider will offer a free touch-up within 2 weeks if adjustments are needed. If they charge for touch-ups, that's a significant hidden cost — and a signal they may not stand behind their work.

The "While You're Here" Upsell

You came in for forehead Botox. The provider suggests crow's feet, lip flip, masseter, and a filler. Suddenly your $350 appointment is $1,200. This isn't necessarily predatory — some suggestions are valid — but go in with a budget and don't feel pressured to add treatments on the spot.

Membership Programs

Many med spas offer monthly memberships ($99–$250/month) that include discounted Botox. These can be genuine savings if you're a regular patient — or expensive commitments if you're not. Do the math: if you get Botox twice a year at $375, that's $750 annually. A $150/month membership is $1,800. It only makes sense if the other included services have real value to you.

Allergan Rewards (All■) vs. Provider Loyalty Programs

Allergan's All■ program gives you points toward future treatments at any All■ provider. This is separate from your provider's own loyalty program. You should be enrolled in both. All■ typically saves $50–$75 per treatment over time.

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■ TOTAL COST CALCULATION

When comparing providers, calculate your **annual cost**, not per-session cost. Include: sessions per year (typically 3–4 for forehead Botox) × per-session cost + consultation fees - loyalty program savings - All■ rewards. A provider charging $375/session with free touch-ups and no consultation fee may be cheaper annually than one charging $300/session with a $100 consult and $50 touch-up fees.

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SECTION 05

7 Questions That Save You Money

Print this page. Bring it to your consultation. These seven questions will save you hundreds of dollars over the course of your treatments — and help you identify the right provider.

1

"Do you charge per unit or per area — and how many units are typical for my treatment?"

This immediately tells you whether you can compare their pricing to other providers. If they can't or won't tell you the unit count, that's a yellow flag.

2

"What's your touch-up policy if I'm not satisfied or the result is asymmetrical?"

The answer should be: complimentary touch-up within 2 weeks. If they charge for adjustments, factor that into your total cost.

3

"How long have you been performing this specific treatment, and how often?"

You want someone who does Botox injections weekly, not monthly. Volume matters for skill. Don't be shy about asking — good providers are proud of their experience.

4

"Do you offer any loyalty programs, and are you an All■ provider?"

If they're not an All■ provider, you're leaving $50–$75 in savings on the table per visit. Most reputable practices participate.

5

"What brand of neurotoxin do you use, and do you offer alternatives?"

Some providers only carry Botox (Allergan). Others offer Dysport, Xeomin, or Daxxify. Having options means you can try what works best for your body — and potentially save money.

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6

"Is there a consultation fee, and is it applied toward treatment?"

No surprises. A $100 consultation fee that isn't applied to treatment is $100 you're paying for someone to look at your face and recommend what you already came in for.

7

"Can I see before-and-after photos of patients with similar anatomy to mine?"

This tests both their skill and their record-keeping. A provider who can show you relevant examples is one who pays attention to outcomes, not just procedures.

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SECTION 06

Red Flags: When Cheap = Dangerous

There's a difference between good value and dangerously cheap. Here are the warning signs that should make you walk out — no matter how good the price looks.

■■ RED FLAG

Prices 40%+ Below Market Average

If the average in your city is $375 and someone's charging $200 for the same treatment, something is off. They may be diluting the product, using non-FDA-approved imports, or employing undertrained staff. A legitimate provider cannot sustain pricing that far below market without cutting corners somewhere.

■■ RED FLAG

No Visible Credentials or Licensing

Your injector should be a licensed medical professional — MD, DO, NP, PA, or RN working under physician supervision. Their license should be displayed in the office. If you can't find their credentials on your state's medical board website, don't let them near your face.

■■ RED FLAG

Pressure to Buy Packages Upfront

"Buy 5 sessions, get 1 free!" before you've even had your first treatment is a sales tactic, not a medical recommendation. A good provider earns your repeat business through results.

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■■ RED FLAG

No Before-and-After Photos Available

If a provider has been practicing for years and can't show you a single before-and-after, either they don't track outcomes (careless) or the outcomes aren't worth showing.

■■ RED FLAG

Botox Parties and Non-Clinical Settings

Botox injections should happen in a clean, clinical environment — not at a house party, nail salon, or pop-up event. Sterile technique matters. Complications require medical equipment on hand. A hotel room doesn't have either.

■■ RED FLAG

Refusing to Disclose Unit Count

If you ask "how many units will I receive?" and the provider deflects, that's a major red flag. You have the right to know exactly what you're paying for.

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SECTION 07

How InjectorIndex TrueScore™ Works

Every provider on InjectorIndex receives a TrueScore — a composite rating from 0 to 100 that goes beyond simple star ratings. Here's exactly how we calculate it, because we believe you deserve to see the methodology behind any score that influences your healthcare decisions.

Component	Weight	What We Measure
Patient Sentiment	30 pts	Semantic analysis of review language — not just stars, but what patients actually say about results, comfort, and communication
Credentials	25 pts	Board certifications, years of practice, specialized training in aesthetic medicine, medical board standing
Review Quality	20 pts	Review volume, recency, platform diversity, and verification signals (filtering fake reviews)
Practice Signals	15 pts	Website quality, appointment availability, transparent pricing, before/after galleries
Transparency	10 pts	Published pricing, clear credential disclosure, touch-up policies, and how easily patients can find information

The Patient Sentiment score is what makes TrueScore different from every other rating system. We use natural language processing to extract meaning from review text — identifying specific quality signals like mentions of natural-looking results, minimal pain, good communication, and long-lasting effects. A provider with fewer reviews but consistently specific praise will outscore one with hundreds of generic 5-star ratings.

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■ WHY WE BUILT THIS

Every existing directory in aesthetic medicine is either pay-to-play (providers pay for visibility), ad-supported (results are ranked by ad spend), or based on simple star averages (easily gamed). InjectorIndex is the first independent, data-driven platform that scores providers based on what patients actually experience. No ads. No sponsored listings. No pay-for-placement.

Find Your Injector

Search 500+ scored providers across 22 cities.
See pricing, credentials, and TrueScore ratings — all free.

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InjectorIndex is an independent research platform that scores medical aesthetics providers using proprietary data analysis. We are not affiliated with any provider, product manufacturer, or medical organization. Our revenue comes from provider subscriptions for enhanced profiles and analytics — never from advertising or sponsored rankings.

Want your city-specific pricing breakdown?

Visit InjectorIndex.com and enter your zip code for provider-level pricing in your area.

DISCLAIMER: This guide is for informational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice. Pricing data is based on publicly available information and provider-reported data as of March 2026. Actual costs may vary. Always consult with a qualified medical professional before undergoing any aesthetic treatment. InjectorIndex does not endorse any specific provider or treatment.

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